
RUSEN BIRBEN

AI & DATA ENGINEER

Ankara, Turkey | contact@rusen.ai
rusen.ai | linkedin.com/in/rusenbirben | github.com/rusenbb
DOB 26/08/2002 | LICENSE B | STATUS AVAILABLE

SUMMARY

AI & Data Engineering graduate from Istanbul Technical University with experience in NLP, LLMs, and agentic AI applications. Co-founder of Fiction Studios, an AI startup at Bilkent Cyberpark building LLM-powered tools for museums and tourists.

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher 04/2026 – Present
METU Applied NLP Group Ankara, TR

Lead METU NLP Connect, the lab's YouTube channel: expert interviews, educational explainers on LLMs and modern NLP, and recent-paper spotlights. Member of the Applied NLP Group (led by Asst. Prof. Çar Toraman), working on LLMs, generative AI, and Turkish language technologies.

Co-Founder 10/2025 – 07/2026
Fiction Studios Ankara, TR

Co-founded an AI startup at Bilkent Cyberpark, an accredited Turkish Teknokent. Built an LLM-powered guide app for museums and tourists. Wound down in 2026.

Junior AI Engineer 03/2025 – 07/2025
CyberQuote Istanbul, TR

Built AI automations and agentic LLM implementations for Phillip Capital subsidiary. Intelligent systems for operations and customer-facing platforms.

NLP Research Intern 07/2024 – 08/2024
ITU NLP Lab Istanbul, TR

Researched LLMs for financial applications: forecasting, sentiment analysis, tool usage, reasoning, and RAG implementations.

AIOps Research Intern 08/2024 – 09/2024
Havelsan Istanbul, TR

AIOps research using software log data for predictive maintenance. Generated demos on HDFS logs.

PROJECTS

Tobor	2024 - 2025
<i>Amazon Warehouse Robot</i>	
Autonomous warehouse robot simulating Amazon logistics. Pathfinding, obstacle avoidance, task scheduling. Human/cargo detection with custom YOLO.	
Python • ROS2 • YOLO • Robotics	[GH] [YT]
Biting The Bytes	2024
<i>Turkish Diacritic Restoration</i>	
T5-based transformer for restoring Turkish diacritics. Automatically adds accent marks and special characters for enhanced readability.	
NLP • T5 • Transformers • Turkish	[GH] [HF]
AlZheimer	2024
<i>Machine Unlearning on SD</i>	
Selectively removed concepts from Stable Diffusion 2.1 while preserving other capabilities. Content moderation and AI output customization.	
Stable Diffusion • Unlearning • CV	[GH]
To-AI-or-Not-to-AI	2023
<i>GPT Detector</i>	
Ensemble method to detect AI-generated text using three fine-tuned models. Addresses academic integrity and misinformation concerns.	
NLP • Ensemble • Classification	[GH] [HF]
Anime Recommender	2022 - 2023
<i>Collaborative Filtering</i>	
Personalized anime recommendations combining collaborative filtering and content-based approaches. RMSE: 0.289, MAE: 0.213.	
RecSys • Matrix Factorization	[GH]

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Computer Engineering (Thesis)	2026 - Present
<i>Middle East Technical University</i>	
B.Sc. AI and Data Engineering	2022 - 2025
<i>Istanbul Technical University</i>	GPA 3.61 / 4.00
B.Sc. Electronics & Communication	2020 - 2022
<i>Istanbul Technical University</i>	
<i>Transferred to AI & Data Engineering</i>	

AWARDS

1416 YLSY Scholarship ü M.Sc. & Ph.D.

Türkiye Ministry of National Education

Türkiye’s flagship state scholarship for graduate study abroad, established under Law No. 1416 (1929). Funds tuition, living stipend, travel, and exam fees for master’s and doctoral programs in exchange for mandatory service at a Turkish university or public institution.

COURSES

Deep Learning Specialization Deeplearning.ai ü Andrew Ng
Sequence Models, CNNs, NN and DL basics, Structuring ML Projects, Improving Deep NNs.

AWS Cloud Technical Essentials AWS ü Coursera
Core AWS concepts, security practices, EC2, Lambda, ECS, RDS, DynamoDB, S3.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES Python • JavaScript/TypeScript • SQL • C/C++
FRAMEWORKS & TOOLS PyTorch • TensorFlow • ROS2 • YOLO • Transformers • Scikit-learn • Pandas • NumPy
SPECIALTIES NLP • LLMs • Computer Vision • RAG • MLOps • Agentic AI • Data Engineering

LANGUAGES

Turkish (Native) **English** (Fluent ü TOEFL iBT 109)

INTERESTS

Coffee • V60 - Aeropress - Moka Pot **Books** • Philosophy - AI/CS - Finance **Anime & Manga** • Watcher - Reader - Collector **Fitness** • Lifting - Running - Calisthenics